# GRAMMAR & BASICS

Lecture 2 Tenses and related topics

# TENSES SESSION 2

The Future

# Future tenses Compared

## What is the difference in meaning?

| |
|---|
| I **will travel** to New York some day. |
| I **am going to travel to** New York this summer. |
| I **am travelling** to New York tomorrow. |
| My plane **leaves** at 15:00. |

# Future tenses Compared

## What is the difference in meaning?

| | |
|---|---|
| I **will travel** to New York some day. | Prediction, neutral attitude |
| I **am going to travel to** New York this summer. | Plan, intention |
| I **am travelling** to New York tomorrow. | Arrangement |
| My plane **leaves** at 15:00. | Fixed in a timetable |

# Will is used…

- For predictions
  - [I think that] Kamala **will** win.
  - Tomorrow **will** [probably, although I don't know] be rainy.
- For decisions made at the moment of speaking
  - [phone ringing] I'**ll** get it / I **will** get it.
  - "John called." –"Ok, I **will** call him back."

# ‘Going to’ is used:

- For plans and intentions
  - I**’m going to buy** a new car.
  - We **are going to visit** my sister on Monday.

- When there are signs of something happening
  - Look at the clouds. It**‘s going to rain**.
  - That vase is tipping on the edge of that shelf. It**’s going to fall** down.

FutureTenses Compared

# What is the difference in meaning?

- Oh, I**'ll buy** some chocolate on my way there.
- (I think/I hope) I**'ll have** so much fun this weekend.
- I think he**'ll fail.**
- I**'m going to buy** some chocolate on my way there.
- I**'m going to have** so much fun this weekend.
- He didn't study. He**'s going to fail**.

# Present forms to talk about the future

- In some cases you can use a present form to talk about the future
- Instead of I **'m going to do** you can also use I **am doing** when talking about plans and intentions
- Especially if you have already made the arrangements
  - We **are flying** to Australia tomorrow.
  - I **am seeing** my dentist next Tuesday
- Make sure to add a reference to the future (tomorrow, next …, etc.) to avoid confusion

# Present forms to talk about the future

- The present form without -ing (I work) is not used often to talk about the future
- It is used when talking about things that are fixed in a schedule or timetable
  - The autumn break **starts** on October 20th.
  - Their plane **arrives** at 10:15

# Agenda

- Recap Tenses
- Tense related topics
  - Questions and negatives
  - Agreement

# Grammatical Tenses: Recap

- What have you remembered about tenses?
- Imagine the following story and try and fill in the correct tenses, if it helps imagine yourself explaining this to someone…

**Next month I (move) …. to a new flat and I (already/buy) … the furniture. I can't wait! Let me tell you more about the flat: there are two big rooms, a kitchenette and a small bathroom. Last weekend I (get) … a very nice lamp for the living room, but unfortunately I (break) … it when I (clean) … the flat. How clumsy of me! Luckily it (not/cost) … much, I (probably/buy) … another one next Saturday.**

**By the way, I have some news to tell you: While I (look) … for the flat, I (meet) … a very nice estate agent: his name is Jamie. We (be)… out for dinner twice and tomorrow we (have) … lunch together. He (work) … near here.**

**Now I (wait) … for my sister. We (go) …to a party together later and I (not/know) … what to wear: my old flat is full of boxes and I can't find a nice dress.**

# Questions and Negations

# Questions and Negations

- Tenses – describe actions
- But language and speaking requires more than 1 person, so we also need to be able to INFORM ABOUT or DENY an action.

*Sentence needs **restructuring** for questions!*
*Sentence needs **adding** for negations!*

# Asking yes/no questions

- **Is** he American?
- **Are** you from around here?

- **Has** he **been** on television?
- **Is** he **playing** football?

- With forms of be (is, am, are, were): move it to the beginning of the sentence

- When there is *more than one verb*: move the first one to the beginning of the sentence

# “Do”-support
# Asking yes/no questions

- If there is only one verb in the sentence
  - I play football
- Add ‘do’ to the beginning of the sentence
  - Do I play football?
- As always add -es, for he, she, it
  - Does he play football?

- Note that the -s is added to ‘do’, not to ‘play’
  - ~~Does he plays football?~~

# Asking yes/no questions about the past

- If there is only one verb in the sentence
  - I played football

- Add 'did' to the beginning of the sentence, and use the normal form of the verb (without -ed)
  - Did I play football?
- This form is the same for you, we, he, she etc.

- Note that only 'did' is the past form, not 'play'
  - ~~Did he played football?~~

# Asking yes/no questions

- Whenever there a helping or modal verb, don't add "do"-support. Just change the word order.
  - You are going → Are you going?
  - She has seen → Has she seen?
  - He doesn't care → Doesn't he care?

  - He will go → Will he go?
  - She can speak → Can she speak?
  - It could work → Could it work?
  - You would like → Would you like?

# “Do”-support Wh-questions

- You can add Wh-words
  - who, what, why, where, which, when, how
  - at the beginning of a question to make another type of question
    - **How** does he travel to school every day?
    - **Why** are we going to school right now?
    - **When** did we go to school?
    - **How long** have you worked there?

# Wh-questions

- Sometimes who, what, or which is the subject of the sentence.
- In that case you just use that word to replace the subject of a normal sentence (you don't use do, does or did)
  - John called Emma → Who called Emma?
  - Amsterdam is the capital of the Netherlands → What is the capital of the Netherlands?
- But if you want to ask about the object you have to use do, does or did
  - John called Emma → Who did John call?

# Wh-questions

- Some more examples
  - Who wants something to eat?
  - ~~Who does want something to eat?~~
  - What happened to you last night?
  - ~~What did happen to you last night?~~

# "Do"-support
# Negative sentences

- Negative sentences are very similar to questions
- Whenever there are two verbs, add 'not' between the two verbs
  - You are going → You are not going
  - She has seen → She has not seen

  - He will go → He will not go
  - She can speak → She cannot speak
  - It could work → It could not work
  - You would like → You would not like

# Negative sentences

- But if there is only one verb in the sentence, we need to use "do"-support (in combination with 'not')
  - I play football → I do not play football
  - He plays football → He does not play football

- Again, the -s is only used for 'does', not for 'play'
  - ~~He does not plays football~~

# Negative sentences in the past

- For the past you use ‘did not’
  - I played football → I did not play football
  - He played football → He did not play football

- Again, only ‘did’ is the past form , not ‘play’
  - ~~I did not played football~~
  - ~~He did not played football~~

# BREAK

# Agreement

# What is Agreement?

- A sentence is made up of a <u>Subject</u> and a <u>Verb</u>

- **SUBJECT** that tells us what/who the sentence is about.
  - It can be either *a noun* e.g.: dancer, book, cars, Sarah, etc. or *a pronoun* (I, he, she, we, they, etc.).
  - It can be either singular or plural.
- **VERB** is the action in a sentence (am/is/are, walk(s), watch(ed),etc.).

- Agreement happens when the Subject and the Verb are linked correctly e.g.: I *walk* – He walk*s*

# Noun forms and verb forms

- When there is 1 of something it's like he, she or it → verb + s
  - The boy gives (he gives)
  - The girl sleeps (she sleeps)
  - The machine works (it works)

- When there is more than 1 of something it's like they, we → normal verb form (without –s)
  - The boys give (they give)
  - The girls sleep (they sleep)
  - The machines work (they work)

# Some verbs don't change

- Will, would, can, could, may, might, must, shall, should

  - The boy will give — the boys will give
  - The girl can sleep — the girls can sleep
  - The machines should work — the machines should work

# Words that can't be counted

- Take the same form as he, she or it
  - Water flows through the pipes.
  - Money makes the world go round.
  - Politics bores me to death.
  - Mathematics gives me headaches.

# Some words always indicate more than one

- These words take the same form as they
  - The cattle are transported to the slaughterhouse.
  - The police have the right to search people.
  - The personnel demand higher pay.

- Also note
  - *Een aantal mensen **is** er al.*
  - ~~A number of people is already there~~
  - A number of people **are** already there.

# Words that refer to a group

- In the UK they get the same form as they, in the US the same form as he, she or it
  - UK: Our family are unable to plan a holiday.
  - US: Our family is unable to plan a holiday.

  - UK: The government are planning a tax reform.
  - US: The government is planning a tax reform.

  - UK: The national football team have won.
  - US: The national football team has won.

# Things with two equal parts

- Things that consist of two equal parts are treated as if there's more than one
  - Trousers, glasses, pants, pyjamas etc.
- They get the same form as they
  - Those trousers make you look fat.
  - My glasses help me read.
- If you want to count these words, you use 2 pairs of… (the form of the verb is still like with they).
  - 2 pairs of pyjamas cost only 20 euros today.

# Note

- Some words look like they refer to more than one, but it is only one
- They take the form of he, she or it
  - The Netherlands has two neighbouring countries.
  - The United States has strict laws.

- If you measure something, use the form of he, she or it, even if it's more than one
  - Ten miles is too far
  - Two kilos seems to be too much.